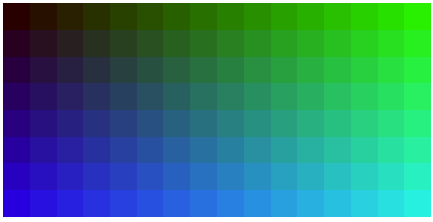
The First Chapter

The keeper climbed the stairs every evening and lit the *great* lamp before the fishing boats came home. He kept a careful record of the weather in a notebook that he called the **Ledger**, and nobody else was allowed to read it.

The Ledger

Its pages were full of small, neat handwriting. Some entries were *underlined twice*, and one of them, from a winter long ago, was marked **urgent** in red ink beside the date.



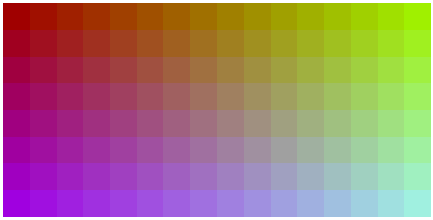
The harbour wall at low tide, seen from the lighthouse.

The Winter Entry

Nobody in the village could explain what had happened that winter, although everyone had a story about it.

The Second Chapter

In the spring the schoolteacher asked to see the notebook. The keeper said **no** at first, but he changed his mind after she told him about the *Mariner*, a ship her grandfather had sailed on.



What They Found

Together they read the winter entry again, slowly, and this time the words made sense to both of them.